

PROJECT SUMMARY REPORT

Before building the dashboard, the goal was simple.

Mario, the owner of Plato's Pizza Restaurant, wanted to understand how his business is performing, when customers buy the most, and which pizza products drive sales.

So, this dashboard was designed to answer those questions in a logical flow, using historical order data to turn raw numbers into meaningful business insights.

DATA & PREPARATION

To achieve this, I analyzed pizza sales data using four datasets:

Orders, Order Details, Pizzas, and Pizza Types. These datasets were connected in Power BI using their common ID columns — Order ID, Pizza ID, and Pizza Type ID — to create a proper data model that supports accurate analysis across all tables.

Before any analysis, data cleaning was carried out in Power Query. This involved removing invalid records, handling missing values, and ensuring that all columns had the correct data types. I also created additional time-based columns, such as day of week and hour of day, from the order date and time. This made it possible to analyze customer demand patterns over time. Key performance measures were then created using DAX, including Total Revenue, Total Orders, Total Pizzas Sold, and Average Order Value.

KPI OVERVIEW – HOW IS THE BUSINESS DOING?

Whenever a business owner opens a dashboard, the first question is usually: "How am I doing overall?" That's why the key performance indicators are placed at the top of the dashboard.

From these KPIs, we can see:

- Total Revenue
- Total Orders

- Total Pizzas Sold
- Average Order Value

Plato's Pizza generated \$817,900 in revenue from approximately 21,000 orders, selling nearly 50,000 pizzas at an average order value of \$38.31. These figures provide an immediate understanding of the scale of the business and customer spending patterns. From the KPIs, we can see that the restaurant operates consistently and has a solid revenue foundation. These figures show that the business is operating at a large scale, with consistent customer spending across orders.

BUSIEST DAYS

After understanding overall performance, the next question is: "When are customers most active?" This chart shows demand by day of the week. From the dashboard, we can see that customer activity increases towards the end of the week, indicating that weekends drive more traffic. This insight is important because it helps management plan staff shifts and manage inventory levels more effectively during high-demand days.

BUSIEST TIMES

Digging deeper into hourly demand, clear peaks appear around midday and early evening, corresponding to lunch and dinner periods. These insights highlight the periods when staff and kitchen operations experience the highest pressure. Understanding these patterns allows the restaurant to plan staffing schedules and manage inventory more efficiently, ensuring a smooth operation even during busy hours.

PIZZA PRODUCED BY HOUR

It's not just about the number of orders, operationally, what matters is how much the kitchen has to produce. So, I also analyzed the number of pizzas sold during peak periods.

During peak hours, pizza production increases significantly, confirming that these periods place higher pressure on kitchen operations and staff. This insight highlights the need for more staff and faster workflows during busy periods.

BEST AND LEAST SELLING PIZZAS

Another important question was: "Which pizzas perform best, and which sell the least?" Analyzing product performance, the dashboard highlights the top-selling pizzas that contribute most to total

revenue. These products represent customer favorites and indicate which items the restaurant should continue to promote. Conversely, the least-selling pizzas reveal opportunities for menu adjustments. Perhaps they require recipe improvements, promotional efforts, or reconsideration on the menu. These insights guide menu optimization and help the restaurant focus on products that truly drive sales.

SEATING CAPACITY INSIGHT

The restaurant has 15 tables with a total seating capacity of 60 seats. Although the dataset does not directly track dine-in seating, the high number of orders observed during peak periods suggests that seating capacity may be under pressure. This implies that during busy hours, the restaurant likely depends on faster table turnover or takeaway orders to meet customer demand. This is an estimated insight based on order volume, not a direct seating measurement.

CONCLUSION & RECOMMENDATIONS

To conclude, this analysis shows that:

- The restaurant experiences clear demand patterns by day and time
- Certain pizza products perform significantly better than others
- And operational pressure is highest during peak hours

Based on these insights, the restaurant can:

- Optimize staff scheduling during peak periods
- Promote best-selling pizzas
- And manage seating more efficiently during busy hours

This project demonstrates how Power BI can transform raw sales data into actionable business insights that support better decision-making.